

Alan Turing

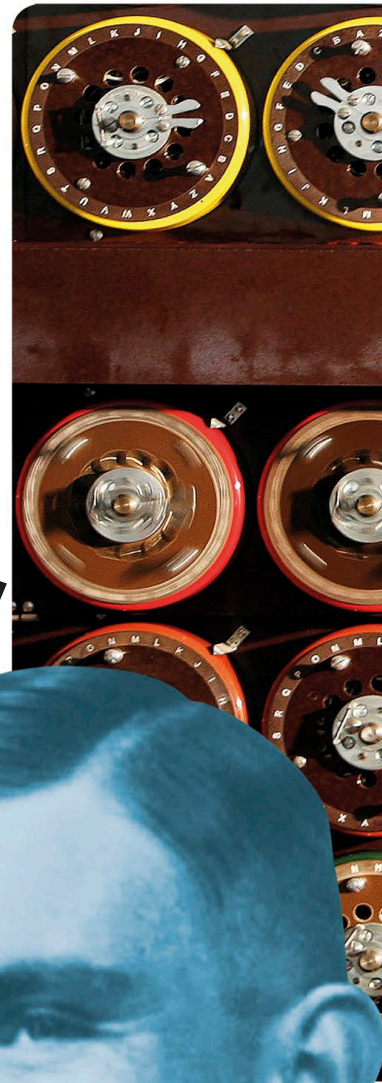
Englishman Alan Turing was a math and science genius. When World War II started, he joined Bletchley Park, a top-secret base, where he worked to break enemy codes and uncover Germany's plans. His inventions and ideas began the age of modern computers.



REALLY?

The Turing Award is a yearly computing prize. Google gives the winner \$1,000,000.

Each Bombe was 7 ft (2 m) wide, and weighed 1 ton (0.9 m tons).



Secret work

Turing's work on codes and computing was so secret that few people were allowed to know about it, even after the war ended. Today, he is recognized as "the father of computing."

Turing machine

In 1936, Turing wrote about an imaginary machine that could perform any task, if it was given the right set of instructions. He never built one, but we call the idea a Turing machine.



Hidden voices

In 1944, Turing helped develop SIGSALY, a secure way of encrypting radio messages using random noise. It was also called the Green Hornet, because anyone listening in would only hear buzzing.

